

channels or generators such as TS404, C_snare, etc. To get a beat going, right-click the generator button, say, TS404 and set the basic tempo. For example, for a faster beat pick 'Fill each two steps' or 'Fill each eight steps' for a slower beat. Hit the Play button on the top bar and you'll have your first basic beat playing.

The beat

The channel window is somewhat like a 'beat map'—there's an indicator of the beat that's playing. The buttons let you manipulate the frequency of the beat. You can stick with a beat playing at regular, faster or slower intervals or you can have irregular beats. Just click on the buttons to select a beat and right-click to 'mute' that beat.

The beat that you'll have playing is the same note playing at the interval that you've set. You'll need to set different notes to each beat. The Piano Roll is where you can do this. Select a channel, say TS404, and click the Piano Roll button at the upper right corner of the window. You'll see a keyboard map for each beat. Here's where you select the note for each beat. It helps if you know a bit about musical notations but even if you don't, just play around till you hear something that sounds good.

Click on the TS404 button to activate the channel settings. This is where you add effects such as delays and distortions, and control the pitch and tempo. Each channel has different settings; there are way too many to talk about all of them here. When you're learning to remix, stick with the simple effects and use the FruityLoops manual to figure out what each effect can do to your loop.

Drag in more sounds such as drums or synthesiser sounds and generate loops and tunes the same way. Keep experimenting till you're satisfied with what you've created. This is how you get a pattern or loop done. You can create more patterns based on different elements, sounds or vocals.

Now you need to bring these patterns together to the FruityLoops playlist and play them together in a sequence. You can have just two or three patterns or several depending on how complex you want your loop to sound. Play around with the sequence of the loop by moving around your patterns with your mouse.

You can save your project in different formats in the complete version, but saving is disabled in the demo version. You can, however, export to WAV, MP3 and MIDI in the demo version through **File > Export**.

Copyrights: How not to go wrong

Hold it right there! Before you start getting all musical, you'll need to check about this one little thing that could get you in big trouble. Most songs produced today are protected by copyright and can't be remixed, edited or distributed in any way, and that includes the free music you download from sites such as MP3.com. So make sure you read the fine print before remixing anything. Sites such as Mixman offer remixable tracks of popular music but you're restricted to a particular file format and the Mixman software. In addition, you can broadcast it only on the Mixman Web site. However, some artistes do offer tracks that they have created for remixes. If you do find a song that you would like to work on, check with the composer or the person who created the song before remixing it.

After you export your file as an MP3, you can drag it into ACID to get it together with the other tunes that you have.

If you have an ear for perfection, you might want to edit your loops in an audio

"Get your decks out and start scratching"—Bally Sagoo

Wondered what the experts use to mix their music? DJ and musician Bally Mix-master Sagoo pioneered the remix genre with *Chura Liya* way back in the 1990s. "Computers have been the most significant thing ever to hit the music scene worldwide," says Sagoo.

"With all these great new programmes, software and downloads coming out each day, you can stretch, move, pitch correct, sample and manipulate sounds. When I started mixing in 1974, I could only dream of doing this." Now with computers, the sky's the limit!

"At the moment, I use a

Macintosh system with several programs, mainly using a sequence program called Logic Audio Platinum," explains Sagoo. He also owns two state-of-the-art professional recording studios in the UK where he works with many famous artists from all over the world, one of which is called BSP Studios (Bally Sagoo Productions). It is here that he's set up his own record label, Ishq Records, and where he produces and writes everyday.

Plan to be a DJ? Sagoo recommends that you get a set of good turntables such as TECHNICS SL1200, a good DJ Mixer with EQ (equalisers) on each channel, and a good CD Mixer.

To get into the groove with remixing, Bally suggests: "You need to spend each and every day getting into mixing from the one side to the other till you feel that you can do fancier stuff like scratching and dropping. When you feel a little more confident, try playing at some parties, entertain your friends and get their feedback. This way you get to 'test drive' your home grown mixes at clubs, before you're ready to release your own creation. This is what I do!

"You can use computers to take your work to a totally different dimension," adds Sagoo. "The best remixers in the world are most definitely DJs or producers who also use computers.

"Being a good remixer is all about having a great knowledge on music, owning a serious music collection, knowing the type of trends that are making noise everywhere, being confident, experimental, and having a great taste about how mixes and blends work while remixing. So, get your decks out and start scratching."

